# 2026 Medica Medicare Prior Authorization and Notification Requirements

**General Information**

Medica requires that providers obtain prior authorization/notification before rendering any services addressed below. This list contains prior authorization (PA) and prior notification requirements (PN) for network providers for inpatient and outpatient services, as referenced in the Medica Provider Administrative Manual. PA does not guarantee payment. To provide PA or notification, please complete the appropriate **Prior Authorization Request Form**, **Inpatient Notification Form** or **Mechanical Circulatory Support Device Notification Form** with supporting clinical documentation as appropriate and submit by fax, e-mail or mail to Medica according to the return information noted on each form.

For services requiring medical prior authorization, post-service reviews will need to be submitted within 10 business days (pre-claim) for a medical necessity review. This means Providers will have 10 days post-service, pre-claim to submit a prior authorization for medical necessity reviews.

If any items on this list are submitted for payment without obtaining a PA, the related claim or claims *will be denied* as provider liability. Access the **Claim Adjustment or Appeal Request Form at medica.com**.

- For PA questions specific to behavioral health for all Medica members, please contact Medica Behavioral Health at 1-800-848-8327.
- *For Medica Prime Solution® Medicare members – PA does not apply*.

**Coding Considerations**

The following codes are included below for informational purposes only and are subject to change without notice. Inclusion or exclusion of a code does not constitute or imply member coverage or provider reimbursement. For Medicare Advantage and MSHO products additional criteria, such as LCD/NCD criteria, may apply.

| Service Category | Medica Policy Name | Current Procedural Terminology (CPT) Codes | Medica Advantage Solution® (HMO-POS and PPO); Medica Advantage® (PPO); Medica Advantage® Dual (PPO D-SNP) | Medica DUAL Solution® (HMO D-SNP) (MSHO); |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Air Ambulance Non-Emergent** | Air Ambulance Non-Emergent (III-MED.08) | A0140, S9960, S9961 | N/A<br><br>Not covered by Medicare | Yes |
| **Breast Reconstruction (non-mastectomy)** | Breast Implant Removal, Revision or Re-implantation (III-SUR.11)<br><br>Female Breast Reduction Surgery – Reduction Mammoplasty (III-SUR.27)<br><br>Male Gynecomastia Surgery (III-SUR.31) | 11970, 19300, 19318, 19328, 19330, 19340, 19342, 19370, 19371, 19380, 19396, 19397, C1789, L8600 | Yes | Yes |
| **Cardiology** | Real-Time Mobile Cardiac Outpatient Telemetry (RT-MCOT) (III-DIA.08) | 93228, 93229 | Yes | Yes |

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|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | |
| **Cardiology –**<br><br>***See Carelon website - https://guidelines.carelonmedicalbenefitsmanagement.com/current-cardiology-guidelines/*** | Cardiac Resynchronization Therapy<br><br>Diagnostic Coronary Angiography<br><br>Endovascular Revascularization<br><br>Imaging of the Heart<br><br>Implantable Cardioverter Defibrillators<br><br>Percutaneous Implantable Pacemakers<br><br>Vascular Imaging | 0238T, 0505T, 0571T, 0572T, 0573T, 0574T, 0620T, 0795T, 0796T, 0797T, 0798T, 0799T, 0800T, 0801T, 0802T, 0803T, 0804T, 33206, 33207, 33208, 33212, 33213, 33214, 33215, 33216, 33217, 33218, 33220, 33221, 33222, 33223, 33224, 33226, 33227, 33228, 33229, 33230, 33231, 33233, 33240, 33241, 33244, 33249, 33262, 33263, 33264, 33270, 33271, 33272, 33273, 33274, 33275, 37262, 37279, 92920, 92924, 92928, 92933, 92937, 92943, 93303, 93304, 93306, 93307, 93308, 93312, 93313, 93314, 93315, 93316, 93317, 93350, 93351, 93454, 93455, 93456, 93457, 93458, 93459, 93460, 93880, 93882, 93922, 93923, 93924, 93925, 93926, 93930, 93931, 93978, 93979, C1721, C1722, C1777, C1785, C1786, C1882, C1895, C1896, C1899, C2619, C2620, C2621, C7521, C7522, C7523, C7524, C7525, C7526, C7527, C7528, C7529, C7531, C7534, C7535, C7537, C7538, C7539, C7540, C7557, C7562, C9600, C9601, C9602, C9603, C9604, C9605, C9607, C9608, G0448 | Yes | Yes |
| **Clinical Trials** | Clinical Trial Utilizing CAR-T Therapy, Bone Marrow or Stem Cell Transplantation (III-MED.10) | Prior Authorization is needed for Evaluation & Actual Transplant | Yes | Yes |
| **Cosmetic and Reconstructive Surgery** | Abdominoplasty / Panniculectomy (III-SUR.13)<br><br>Blepharoplasty, Blepharoptosis Repair and Brow Lift (III-SUR.29)<br><br>Rhinoplasty and Other Nasal Procedures (III-SUR.04)<br><br>Otoplasty (III-SUR.31) | 15820, 15821, 15822, 15823, 15830, 15839, 15847, 21280, 21282, 30400, 30410, 30420, 30430, 30435, 30450, 30460, 30462, 30465, 30468, 67900, 67901, 67902, 67903, 67904, 67906, 67908, 67909, 67950, 69300<br>If specific policy does not apply, requests will be reviewed as per member plan documents, Cosmetic and/or Reconstructive Surgery | Yes | Yes |


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|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Drugs (Provider-Administered Drugs Under the Medical Benefit)** | Please refer to the Drug Management Policies for each drug and select the appropriate Prior Authorization Form, as needed. | | Refer to the Prime Therapeutics website for Medica Clinical Guidelines | Refer to the Prime Therapeutics website for Medica Clinical Guidelines |
| **Durable Medical Equipment** | All other codes not listed are managed by appropriate NCDs/LCDs | Orthosis (Spinal and Knee):<br>L0648, L0650, L1832, L1833, L1851<br><br>Power Flotation Bed and Mattresses Overlays:<br>E0193; E0277; E0371; E0372; E0373 | Yes | Yes |
| | Bone Growth Stimulators – Electrical (Long Bones) and Ultrasound (III-DEV.07)<br><br>For Electrical Bone Growth Stimulation (Noninvasive) of the spine, see Musculoskeletal, Spine, below. | E0747, E0749, E0760, 20974, 20975, 20979<br><br>E0748 | Yes<br><br>Yes | Yes<br><br>Yes |
| | High Frequency Chest Wall Compression (HFCWC) Devices (III-DEV.20) | A7025, A7026, E0483 | Yes | Yes |
| | Home Continuous Glucose Monitors | A4238, A4239, E2102, E2103 | Yes | Yes |
| | Microprocessor Controlled Knee Prostheses, with or without Polycentric, Three-Dimensional Endoskeletal Hip Joint System (III-DEV.17) | L5856, L5857, L5858, L5859, L5930, L5961 | Yes | Yes |
| | Wheelchairs, Scooters and Accessories (III-DEV.25) | All wheelchair & power operated vehicle (scooter) codes (including wheelchair accessories, repair, and modification codes) that are an average purchase fee schedule of $1000 or greater or an average rental fee schedule of $100 or greater. | Yes | Yes |


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|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Gastroesophageal Reflux Disease Surgery** | Magnetic Esophageal Ring for the Treatment of Gastroesophageal Reflux Disease (III.SUR.42) | 43284 | N/A<br><br>Not covered by Medicare | Yes |
| **Gender-Affirming Surgery or Procedure** | Gender Affirmation Procedures (III-SUR.20) | **The following codes require PA in conjunction with gender-affirming surgery or procedure:**<br>15839, 19301, 19302, 19303, 19304, 19305, 19306, 19307, 19316, 19318, 19324, 19325, 19350, 53415, 53420, 53425, 53430, 54120, 54125, 54130, 54135, 54400, 54401, 54405, 54520, 54522, 54660, 54690, 55175, 55180, 55866, 55970,55980, 56625, 56800, 56805, 57106, 57107, 57109, 57110, 57111, 57112, 57291, 57292, 57335, 58150, 58152, 58180, 58200, 58210, 58260, 58262, 58263, 58267, 58270, 58275, 58280, 58285, 58290, 58291, 58292, 58293, 58294, 58541, 58542, 58543, 58550, 58552, 58553, 58554, 58570, 58571, 58572, 58573, 58661, 58720, 11920, 11921, 11922, 11950, 11951, 11952, 11954, 14000, 14001, 14041, 15734, 15738, 15750, 15757, 15758, 15769, 15771, 15772, 15773, 15774, 15780, 15781, 15783, 15786, 15787, 15788, 15789, 15792, 15793, 15819, 15824, 15825, 15826, 15828, 15829, 15832, 15833, 15834, 15835, 15836, 15837, 15838, 15876, 15878, 15879, 17380, 17999, 21137, 21138, 21139, 21172, 21175, 21179, 21180, 21208, 21209, 21210, 21215, 21230, 21235, 21270, 21899, 31599, 31899, 40799, 53410, 56620, 56810, 58544, 58940, 64856, 64892, 64896, | Yes | Yes |
| **Home Health Care: Non-Medicaid Products** | Extended Hours Home Care (Skilled Nursing Services) (III-HOM.01)<br><br>Home Health Aide (III-HOM.02) | G0156, G0490, G0496, S9122, S9123, S9124, T1000, T1002, T1003, T1004, T1021 | No | N/A |
| **Home Health Care: Medicaid Products** | Minnesota Medicaid Personal Care Assistance (PCA) Services/ Community First Services and Supports (CFSS) (III-HOM.03)<br><br>Medicaid Home Health Aide (III-HOM.04) | G0156, G0162, S9123, T1002, T1003, T1004, T1019, T1021, 99505, 99506, 99507, 99511, 99512 | N/A | Authorization obtained from the Care Coordinator |


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|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Medicaid Home Care Nursing (HCN) Services (III-HOM.05) | | | |
| **Inpatient Hospital, Medical/Surgical**<br>*Notification* is required (see General Information on page 1 for link to form)<br>• Upon admission<br>• In the event of an emergency admission, notify Medica within 24 hours after the admission.<br>• Provide Medica discharge instructions and discharge date. | Inpatient (Hospital) Level of Care (III-INP.01) | No specific coding | Notification<br><br>Yes, if out-of-network | Notification<br><br>Yes, if out-of-network |
| **Inpatient Hospital, Mental Health, and/or Substance Use Disorder** | ***See Optum Provider Express website:***<br><br>**https://public.providerexpress.com/content/ope-provexpr/us/en/clinical-resources/guidelines-policies.html** | No specific coding | Notification only<br><br>To notify, contact Medica Behavioral Health (MBH) at 1-800-848-8327. | Notification only<br><br>To notify, contact Medica Behavioral Health (MBH) at 1-800-848-8327. |
| **Inpatient Rehabilitation Facility** | Inpatient Rehabilitation Facility (Acute Rehabilitation) (III-INP.05) | No specific coding | Yes | Yes |
| **Long Term Acute Care Hospital (LTACH)** | Long Term Acute Care Hospital (LTACH) (III-INP.04) | No specific coding | Yes | Yes |
| **Mechanical Circulatory Support Devices**<br>*Notification* is required (see General Information on page 1 for link to form)<br>• Ventricular assist devices (VAD)<br>• Total artificial heart (TAH) devices | Mechanical Circulatory Support Devices (Coverage Policy) | 33927, 33928, 33929, 33975, 33976, 33979, 33990, 33991, 33995 | Notification only | Notification only |
| **Metabolic and Bariatric Surgery** | Metabolic and Bariatric Surgery (III-SUR.30) | 43291, 43644, 43645, 43770, 43771, 43773, 43775, 43842, 43843, 43845, 43846, 43847, 43848, 43860, 43865, 43886, 43888 | Yes | Yes |


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|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | 43659 and 43999 require prior authorization when related to bariatric surgery. | | |
| **Musculoskeletal Procedures, Interventional Pain Management**<br><br>***See Carelon website:*** ***https://guidelines.carelonmedicalbenefitsmanagement.com/current-musculoskeletal-guidelines/*** | Epidural Injection Procedures & Diagnostic Selective Nerve Root Blocks<br><br>Paravertebral Facet Injection/Medial Branch Nerve Block/Neurolysis (e.g., percutaneous denervation procedures)<br><br>Regional Sympathetic Nerve Block<br><br>Sacroiliac Joint Injection<br><br>Spinal Cord and Nerve Root Stimulators | 27096, 62280, 62281, 62282, 62292, 62320, 62321, 62322, 62323, 62324, 62325, 62326, 62327, 63650, 63655, 63663, 63664, 63685, 63688, 64451, 64479, 64480, 64483, 64484, 64490, 64491, 64492, 64493, 64494, 64495, 64510, 64520, 64625, 64628, 64629, 64633, 64634, 64635, 64636, G0260, 0213T, 0214T, 0215T, 0216T, 0217T, 0218T | Yes | Yes |
| **Musculoskeletal Procedures, (Large) Joint Surgery –**<br><br>***See Carelon website:*** ***https://guidelines.carelonmedicalbenefitsmanagement.com/current-musculoskeletal-guidelines/*** | Hip<br>• Arthroplasty<br>• Arthroscopy & Open Procedures<br><br>Knee<br>• Arthroplasty<br>• Arthroscopy & Open Procedures<br>• Autologous Chondrocyte Implantation of the Knee<br><br>Shoulder<br>• Arthroplasty<br>• Arthroscopy & Open Procedures | 23105, 23107, 23120, 23130, 23410, 23412, 23415, 23420, 23430, 23440, 23450, 23455, 23460, 23462, 23465, 23466, 23470, 23472, 23473, 23474, 23700, 27120, 27122, 27125, 27130, 27132, 27134, 27137, 27138, 27331, 27332, 27333, 27334, 27335, 27345, 27403, 27405, 27407, 27409, 27412, 27415, 27416, 27418, 27420, 27422, 27424, 27425, 27427, 27428, 27429, 27437, 27438, 27440, 27441, 27442, 27443, 27445, 27446, 27447, 27486, 27487, 27488, 27570, 28446, 29805, 29806, 29807, 29819, 29820, 29821, 29822, 29823, 29824, 29825, 29827, 29828, 29860, 29861, 29862, 29863, 29866, 29867, 29868, 29870, 29871, 29873, 29874, 29875, 29876, 29877, 29879, 29880, 29881, 29882, 29883, 29884, 29885, 29886, 29887, 29888, 29889, 29892, 29914, 29915, 29916, G0289, G0428, J7330, S2112, S2118, | Yes | Yes |
| **Musculoskeletal Procedures, Spine –** | Cervical<br>• Decompression With/Without Fusion | 20930, 20931, 20936, 20937, 20938, 20939, 22206, 22207, 22208, 22210, 22212, 22214, 22216, 22220, 22222, 22224, 22226, 22510, 22511, 22512, 22513, 22514, 22515, 22532, 22533, 22534, 22548, 22551, | Yes | Yes |


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|---|---|---|---|---|
| ***See Carelon website: https://guidelines.carelonmedicalbenefitsmanagement.com/current-musculoskeletal-guidelines/*** | • Disc Arthroplasty<br><br>Lumbar<br>• Discectomy, Foraminotomy, & Laminotomy<br>• Laminectomy<br>• Fusion & Treatment of Spinal Deformity<br>• Disc Arthroplasty<br>• Posterolateral or Intertransverse Lumbar Fusion (autograft not feasible)<br><br>Sacroiliac Joint Fusion (Percutaneous/Minimally Invasive Techniques, Open)<br><br>Electrical Bone Growth Stimulation, Noninvasive - spine<br><br>Vertebroplasty/ Kyphoplasty<br><br>Bone Graft Substitutes and Bone Morphogenic Proteins<br><br>Anterior Lumbar Interbody Fusion (ALIF) or Lateral Lumber Interbody Fusion (i.e., XLIF) | 22552, 22554, 22556, 22558, 22585, 22590, 22595, 22600, 22610, 22612, 22614, 22630, 22632, 22633, 22634, 22800, 22802, 22804, 22808, 22810, 22812, 22818, 22819, 22830, 22840, 22841, 22842, 22843, 22844, 22845, 22846, 22847, 22848, 22849, 22853, 22854, 22856, 22857, 22858, 22859, 22860, 22861, 22862, 22864, 22865, 27278, 27279, 27280, 63001, 63003, 63005, 63012, 63015, 63016, 63017, 63020, 63030, 63035, 63040, 63042, 63043, 63044, 63045, 63046, 63047, 63048, 63050, 63051, 63052, 63053, 63055, 63056, 63057, 63075, 63076, 63081, 63082, 63085, 63086, 63087, 63088, 63090, 63091, 63101, 63102, 63103, 63185, 63190, 63191, 63200, 63250, 63252, 63265, 63267, 63270, 63272, 63275, 63277, 63280, 63285, 63287, 63290, 63300, 63301, 63302, 63303, 63304, 63305, 63306, 63307, 63308, 64628, 64629, C7504, C7505, C7507, C7508, C9359, C9362, E0748, 0095T, 0098T, 0164T, 0165T, 0200T, 0201T | | |
| **Nutritional Services** | Outpatient Enteral Nutrition Therapy<br><br>Note: For amino acid therapy (only) refer to Medica coverage policy *Amino Acid Based Elemental Formulas* (B4153, B4161). | B4102, B4103, B4105, B4149, B4150, B4152, B4153, B4154, B4155, B4157, B4158, B4159, B4160, B4161, B4162, B4187 | Yes | Authorization obtained from Care Coordinator |
| **Orthognathic Surgery** | Orthognathic Surgery | 21085, 21110, 21120, 21121, 21122, 21123, 21125, 21127, 21141, 21142, 21143, 21145, 21146, 21147, 21150, 21151, 21154, 21155, 21159, 21160, 21193, 21194, 21195, 21196, 21198, 21199, 21206, 21208, 21209, 21210, 21215, 21244, 21245, 21246, 21247, | Yes | Yes |


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|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | 21248, 21249, 21255, 21685, D7941, D7943, D7944, D7945, D7940, D7946, D7947, D7948, D7949, D7950, D7995, D7996 | | |
| **Out-of-Network Services**<br>This does not include emergency services. | | No specific coding | Yes | Yes |
| **Rare Diseases (Minnesota only)** | Rare Diseases: Access to Out-of-Network Diagnosis, Monitoring, and Treatment | No specific coding | No | Yes<br>Identification as a rare disease requires prior authorization |
| **Radiology Services -**<br><br>***See Carelon website: https://guidelines.carelonmedicalbenefitsmanagement.com/current-radiology-guidelines/*** | Services included:<br>Selected applications of the following:<br>• Computed Tomography (CT)<br>• Low-dose CT<br>• Magnetic resonance imaging (MRI)<br>• Functional MRI<br>• Magnetic resonance spectroscopy<br>• Magnetic resonance cholangiopancreatography (MRCP)<br>• Magnetoencephalography (MEG)/Magnetic Source Imaging (MSI)Positron emission tomography (PET)<br>• CT or MR arthrography<br>• Low-field MRI<br>• MR-guided Procedures<br>• Nuclear Medicine Imaging<br>• Oncologic Imaging<br>• SPECT Imaging<br>• Vascular Imaging | 70336, 70450, 70460, 70470, 70471, 70480, 70481, 70482, 70486, 70487, 70488, 70490, 70491, 70492, 70496, 70498, 70540, 70542, 70543, 70544, 70545, 70546, 70547, 70548, 70549, 70551, 70552, 70553, 70554, 70555, 71250, 71260, 71270, 71271, 71275, 71550, 71551, 71552, 71555, 72125, 72126, 72127, 72128, 72129, 72130, 72131, 72132, 72133, 72141, 72142, 72146, 72147, 72148, 72149, 72156, 72157, 72158, 72159, 72191, 72192, 72193, 72194, 72195, 72196, 72197, 72198, 73200, 73201, 73202, 73206, 73218, 73219, 73220, 73221, 73222, 73223, 73225, 73700, 73701, 73702, 73706, 73718, 73719, 73720, 73721, 73722, 73723, 73725, 74150, 74160, 74170, 74174, 74175, 74176, 74177, 74178, 74181, 74182, 74183, 74185, 74261, 74262, 74263, 74712, 75557, 75559, 75561, 75563, 75571, 75572, 75573, 75574, 75580, 75635, 76390, 76391, 77046, 77047, 77048, 77049, 77078, 77084, 78429, 78430, 78431, 78432, 78433, 78451, 78452, 78453, 78454, 78459, 78466, 78468, 78469, 78472, 78473, 78481, 78483, 78491, 78492, 78494, 78608, 78609, 78811, 78812, 78813, 78814, 78815, 78816, 95965, 95966, 0633T, 0634T, 0635T, 0636T, 0637T, 0638T, 0648T, 0861T, S8037, S8042, S8092 | Yes | Yes |
| **Residential Treatment Facility, Mental Health** | **See Optum Website Provider Express:** | No specific coding | Yes | Yes |


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|---|---|---|---|---|
| | ***https://public.providerexpress.com/content/ope-provexpr/us/en/clinical-resources/guidelines-policies.html*** | | To obtain prior authorization, contact Medica Behavioral Health (MBH) at 1-800-848-8327. | To obtain prior authorization, contact Medica Behavioral Health (MBH) at 1-800-848-8327. |
| **Residential Treatment Facility, Substance Use** | **See Optum Website Provider Express:** ***https://public.providerexpress.com/content/ope-provexpr/us/en/clinical-resources/guidelines-policies.html*** | No specific coding | Notification Only<br><br>To submit notification, contact Medica Behavioral Health (MBH) at 1-800-848-8327. | Notification Only<br><br>To submit notification, contact Medica Behavioral Health (MBH) at 1-800-848-8327. |
| **Skilled Nursing Facility**<br>Includes extended care facility, and transitional care unit. | Skilled Nursing Facility | No specific coding | Yes<br><br>Critical Access Hospitals swing bed requires notification only | Yes<br><br>Critical Access Hospitals swing bed requires notification only |
| **Sleep apnea procedures and surgeries** | Facility-Based Polysomnography, (Sleep Studies) for Obstructive Sleep Apnea, Adults | 95807, 95808, 95810, 95811, | Yes | Yes |
| | Implanted Hypoglossal Nerve Stimulation for Treatment of Obstructive Sleep Apnea | 64582, 64568, 64569 | Yes | Yes |
| | Uvulopalatopharyngoplasty (UPPP or U3P) for Obstructive Sleep Apnea/Hypopnea Syndrome | 42145 | Yes | Yes |
| **Transplant Services** | Bone Marrow or Stem Cell (Peripheral or Umbilical Cord Blood) Transplantation<br><br>Heart/Lung Transplantation<br><br>Heart Transplantation (Adult and Pediatric)<br><br>Intestinal Transplantation<br><br>Kidney Transplantation<br><br>Liver Transplantation | Prior Authorization is needed for Evaluation & Actual transplant | Yes | Yes |


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|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Lung Transplantation (Single or Double)<br>Pancreas – Kidney (SPK, PAK) Transplantation<br>Pancreas Transplantation (Pancreas Alone) | | | |
| **Vagus Nerve Stimulation** | Vagus Nerve Stimulation | 64568, 64553 | Yes | Yes |
| **Vein Procedures** | Varicose Vein and Venous Insufficiency Treatments: | 0524T, 36465, 36466, 36470, 36471, 36475, 36478, 36482, 36483, 37500, 37700, 37718, 37722, 37735, 37760, 37761, 37765, 37766, 37785 | Yes | Yes |


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